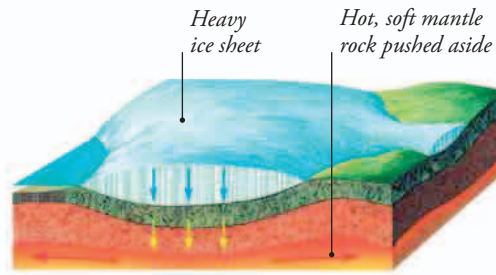
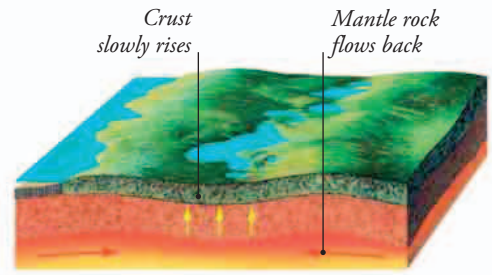


BOUNCING BACK

When many parts of the northern continents were covered by thick ice, the weight of ice pressed down on the Earth's crust, pushing aside the softer mantle rock below. When the ice melted, the crust started rising, but slowly. As a result, shores that were once beaches are now high above sea level, and are still rising.



Ice weighs down the land



Ice melts and land rises

FLOODED VALLEYS

As the ice age ended and the ice sheets melted, all the meltwater flowed into the sea, raising global sea levels. By 6,000 years ago, seas had reached the same level as today, drowning many landscapes that had formed during the ice age. For example, deep valleys that had once contained icy glaciers were flooded to create steep-sided fjords.

▼ GEIRANGERFJORD

During the ice age, this flooded fjord on the coast of Norway lay high above sea level.

WOW!

Many northern shores are rising by 3 ft (1 m) a century. Ports used by the Vikings 1,000 years ago are now 33 ft (10 m) above sea level.

